

Farrer & Co

Complete firm and application research — history & positioning, practice areas, clients, culture, pro bono, apprenticeship structure, application guidance and personal notes.

- Founded:** 1701 — one of the oldest UK law firms
- Office:** Single London office, 66 Lincoln's Inn Fields
- Programme:** Solicitor Apprenticeship (4 days a week working)
- Rotations include:** Commercial, Contentious, Private Client, Property, Business Services
- Notable:** Advises the British Royal Family; historic client Charles Dickens

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1. Firm Overview & History

- One of the oldest UK law firms — founded in 1701, with three centuries of legal service
- Long history of prestigious clients, including advising the British Royal Family; Charles Dickens was a historic client
- Single London headquarters at 66 Lincoln's Inn Fields — described as "truly international" despite the single-office model
- Central London location signals credibility and proximity to key legal institutions
- Rather than building offices globally, the firm curates global reach by partnering with trusted external counsel, prioritising client outcomes and quiet collaboration over branding via global presence
- Draws on a close network of third-party advisers, including communications experts, digital intelligence and investigations firms, cyber and physical security advisers, and specialist barristers
- Combines deep tradition with modern relevance

2. Position in the Market & USP

- Top 10 UK law firm by average claim value in English High Court disputes
- Positioned between the big disputes firms and bespoke private client practices — a combination few firms can offer
- Has intentionally resisted international office sprawl despite having a client base that could justify it — this is control, not conservatism
- HNW, reputational and institutional clients value consistency, confidentiality and partner continuity over geographic footprint
- Operates in a sophisticated, quiet, strategic way
- Private client work is one of the strongest fee-income growth areas currently, so demand remains robust
- London continues to manage a substantial share of private capital and high-net-worth families, though this is shifting due to tax changes
- Technology is being developed to manage work and increase client intake and efficiency — clients can expect predictable billing and hybrid communication models, integrating technology without losing personalised service

Competitors: Withers (clients include 78% of the Top 100 Rich List; similarly strong in estate planning and family) and Mishcon de Reya (strong for breadth). Neither replicates Farrer's unique combination of hereditary client trust, specialist institutional sectors, and discreet, high-stakes advisory work.

3. Practice Areas & Sectors

Farrer & Co is not a full-service firm, but offers expert advice across a wide range of specialist practice areas.

ART & CULTURAL PROPERTY	LUXURY ASSETS	REPUTATION MANAGEMENT	LANDED ESTATES	PRIVATE CLIENT	CHARITIES	FAMILY
EMPLOYMENT	TAX & TRUSTS	EDUCATION	MEDIA & ENTERTAINMENT	DISPUTES		

- Constantly ranked market leader for UK reputation management law (commercial defamation and crisis work), having moved past traditional work into "right to be forgotten" and content removal strategies
- The landed estates team is the largest in the UK, covering tax, trusts, family and employment work for some of the country's most significant landed estates, families and rural businesses
- Litigation work is high value and selective — rights-sensitive and high-impact
- Significant work in the education sector
- Ranked Band 1 / Tier 1 across both traditional heritage sectors (Agriculture & Rural Affairs, Art & Cultural Property) and modern commercial realms (Charities, Media & Entertainment) — a dual strength that is uncommon, since most firms are either commerce-led or private client/heritage-led, rarely both

4. Art & Cultural Property Law

As leading legal specialists in the art and cultural property sector, the firm understands the art market deeply. Its client base includes collectors, artists, dealers, banks, landed estates, charitable foundations, museums and leading galleries.

Experience in this field is extensive — as far back as 1820, the firm advised the Duke of Wellington on the insurance of his art collection. Today, the firm advises clients buying NFTs. Whether advising on the sale of a major collection, a title dispute, structuring and financing a purchase, or a compliance and regulatory issue, the team has the expertise to navigate this evolving market.

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Authenticity and provenance issues• Consignment agreements• Acquisition and sale of art and luxury assets• Art finance, investment and third-party guarantees | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Art and estate succession planning• Copyright protection and licensing• Art insurance (including the Government Indemnity Scheme)• Art litigation and recovery of stolen artwork; reputation management and handling media |
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5. Luxury Assets

Farrer & Co's experience in luxury assets is extensive — yachts, classic cars, private jets, art, super-prime London or countryside residential property, landed estates, trophy commercial properties, jewellery, wine and other luxury collectibles. The firm offers comprehensive legal advice to ensure these investments are protected and positioned to thrive.

- ACQUISITION & SALE
- FINANCING
- RESTRUCTURING OWNERSHIP
- SUCCESSION PLANNING
- DISPUTE RESOLUTION
- INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY
- REAL ESTATE
- REPUTATION MANAGEMENT & MEDIA
- GIFTS & PHILANTHROPY

6. Reputation Management & Crisis Work

- Consistently ranked as market leader for UK reputation management law, spanning commercial defamation and crisis work
- Has developed beyond traditional practice into "right to be forgotten" and content removal strategies
- Farrer's advice often shapes client behaviour before litigation risk crystallises — commercially and emotionally valuable for clients whose public standing is their capital
- Threats are no longer confined to mainstream press and broadcast media — the online and digital world makes it easier than ever for false or malicious information to spread, posing an immediate threat to reputation, privacy and security
- The firm draws on a close network of third-party advisers — communications experts, digital intelligence and investigations firms, cyber and physical security advisers, and specialist barristers — to support this work

7. Landed Estates & Private Client

- The landed estates team is the largest in the UK, covering tax, trusts, family and employment
- Recognised by legal directories as the leading law firm in this sector, advising some of the country's most significant landed estates, families and rural businesses
- The firm works to a 360-degree approach to client problems — preserving heritage, maximising commercial opportunities, or balancing family interests, depending on what the client needs
- Builds enduring relationships with clients, working in a way that reflects the client's own values, rather than a one-size-fits-all approach
- The non-domicile tax regime change from April 2025 (applying inheritance tax to worldwide assets after 10 years of residence) has implications for international families and wealth structures — relevant context for private client work

Our approach is built on trust, discretion, and a genuine commitment to your long-term success. We take the time to understand your priorities — whether preserving heritage, maximising commercial opportunities, or balancing family interests.

— Firm statement

8. Clients & Competitors

The firm's niche is private capital, but it also works with a number of household names as well as high-net-worth individuals.

- The Football Association — reputation law
- The Economist — reputation law
- Cultural bodies — museums, education
- Many long-standing, generational client relationships

Competitors

- Withers** — clients include 78% of the Top 100 Rich List; similarly strong in estate planning and family work
- Mishcon de Reya** — also a competitor on breadth of service
- Neither replicates Farrer's specific combination of hereditary client trust, specialist institutional sectors, and discreet, high-stakes advisory work

9. Industry Trends & Context

The Great Wealth Transfer

Around \$83 trillion will pass to younger generations over the next two decades. Millennials and Gen Z are reshaping priorities, often valuing wellbeing, social responsibility and ethical tax behaviour over traditional wealth preservation.

Increasing mental incapacity

Longer life expectancy and rising dementia rates present major challenges for advisers around capacity, consent and fiduciary decision-making, with legal frameworks struggling to keep pace.

Reputation risk and misinformation

AI-driven misinformation and "cancel culture" mean reputations can be damaged rapidly. Crisis planning and narrative control are now essential components of private wealth advice.

AI and the premium on emotional intelligence

While AI will automate technical work and accelerate wealth creation, advisers will differentiate themselves through judgement, emotional intelligence, and the ability to identify clients' unspoken concerns.

Neurodivergent wealth creators

Many new wealth creators are neurodivergent and challenge traditional communication and advisory models. Advisers must adapt their approach and foster neurodiversity internally to serve clients effectively.

A more litigious environment

Multi-generational wealth, longer lifespans and aggressive tax enforcement are driving more disputes — both within families and between clients and authorities.

10. Recent Cases

- **PN v SA** — represented the wife in one of the largest divorce settlements in England, securing £230.78m for the client. Established that persistent conduct, without explosive confrontation, can amount to coercive influence undermining free will in marital agreements
- **JUSTICE / UN submission** — contributed pro bono to support JUSTICE's submission to the UN on how AI should interact with judicial systems

11. Awards & Recognition

- Tier 1 rankings across numerous practice areas; top Legal 500 recognitions
- Ranked Band 1 / Tier 1 across both heritage sectors (Agriculture & Rural Affairs, Art & Cultural Property) and modern commercial realms (Charities, Media & Entertainment)
- **Law Firm of the Year** — 2025 Women & Diversity in Law Awards, recognising the firm's Conscious Inclusion strategy and culture
- **2025 Inspire Award (EMEA)** — from NetDocuments, for outstanding use of legal technology and innovation, reflecting leadership in digital transformation and tech adoption within legal services
- Chambers High Net Worth Awards 2025 — shortlisted for Private Client Team of the Year and Family Team of the Year
- Farrer & Co and Young People's Life Café won Most Effective Partnership at the LawWorks Pro Bono Awards 2025

12. Culture & Values

Stated values

INTEGRITY

EXCELLENCE

PARTNERSHIP

Conscious Inclusion — BALANCE, PRIDE, REACH, RISE, THRIVE

- A conscious inclusion strategy embedding equity into policy and practice
- Externally recognised for this work — Law Firm of the Year and shortlisted in multiple Women and Diversity in Law Awards
- 68% of associates are female
- Gender equity employee impact group described as close-knit
- Featured among the Top 75 Employers for the Social Mobility Foundation
- Part of the 10,000 Black Interns programme

Work style & balance

- Good work-life balance and flexible arrangements
- Average leaving time is around 6:30pm, even when busy
- Trainees continually encouraged to maintain interests and hobbies outside of work
- A wide range of social clubs, from Pilates to cricket, plus an extra day of holiday at Christmas
- Described as a firm that genuinely hires interesting people, with time made for coffee, lunch or dinner together

Training & trainee experience

- Supervision is tailored and individual
- Emphasis on collaboration across disciplines
- Trainees are seen as the future of the firm, with lots of responsibility on offer from day one
- Mandatory and voluntary training sessions, alongside lots of client interaction
- Work described as quirky, unconventional and challenging for an apprentice
- Trainees report feeling completely trusted from their first day, and that all trainees get on well together
- Senior people give time generously
- Insiders describe the training as exceptional — no other firm offers training quite like it

Insiders explain training as exceptional. Trainees are the future of the firm.

— Insider/trainee account

Farrers seems to hire genuinely interesting people with lots of things to talk about. People are always able to find time for a coffee or to arrange lunch or dinner.

— Insider account

Crucially it's not all talk and certainly moving in the right direction — a place I am proud to work.

— Insider account

Other cultural notes

- An environment where individuals are celebrated and encouraged to bring forward their own ideas
- Has maintained distinctive qualities through change; friendly, and encourages people to be themselves
- Assessment across categories: A* work-life balance, A training, A* work quality; legal tech currently rated B, though reportedly growing in this area
- Characterful and distinctive, with a strong ethos of humanity and kindness
- Colleagues described as supportive, intelligent and effective
- The Church of the Bank of England is signed in nearby; Charles Dickens was a historic client — a sense of characterful history throughout the firm
- Discreet and confidential by nature — being part of the firm is described as a privilege

13. Responsible Business & Pro Bono

- The charity team is market-leading — ranked 1 in Legal 500
- Farrer's advice often comes during moments of institutional stress, not just steady-state governance — meaning its advice shapes how organisations retain public confidence
- Many charity clients operate in education, safeguarding, religion and youth services — sectors where governance failure leads to national scrutiny
- Significant work in the education sector generally

Young People's Life Café

A pro bono initiative where the firm's solicitors advise young people with a terminal diagnosis about wills and probate. Run in conjunction with counsellors at a hospital cancer service, involving colleagues from the Private Client team. Farrer & Co and Young People's Life Café won **Most Effective Partnership** at the LawWorks Pro Bono Awards 2025.

Community & giving

- Partnerships such as the collaboration with Neighbourly, and many other community initiatives, make it easy for anyone at the firm to contribute to causes that matter
- The Farrer & Co Charitable Trust was established by the partners over 40 years ago to support charities alleviating rough sleeping in Lincoln's Inn Fields; its impact has since broadened to include increasing access to justice and other charitable work by firm members
- A wide range of ways to get involved — from bake-offs and jumper days to London walks and reading with school children

This commitment isn't just about the initiatives we undertake — it's a deeply embedded part of our culture, shaped over decades of purposeful action.

— Firm statement

14. Apprenticeship Details

- Working pattern: 4 days a week
- Departments/rotations: Commercial, Contentious, Private Client, Property, Business Services
- Relocation support available

Check the current live listing for the latest salary and deadline figures, as these weren't confirmed in these notes.

15. Application Guidance (From the Firm)

Work history section

Any attendance at, or participation in, legal open days or events should be addressed under the "steps taken to prepare for a career in law" question, rather than in the work history section itself.

Motivations for a career in law

Candidates should showcase their motivations to pursue a career in law — this might include life experiences that led towards law (the environment where you grew up, an inspirational friend or colleague, a book, a news article, a blog/vlog, a YouTube video, a podcast). The firm wants to see genuine research demonstrating confidence that being a solicitor is something you will enjoy and excel in — including understanding of the solicitor role and why it was chosen over other legal careers, such as becoming a barrister.

Why an apprenticeship over university

Detail why a solicitor apprenticeship was chosen over attending university as the route into law. The firm wants to see genuine understanding of what a solicitor apprenticeship is, how it works in practice, and what it leads to.

Academic preparation

Share the range of transferable skills gained from formal education and additional qualifications applicable to life as a solicitor — this might include school studies, college, an EPQ, or a relevant online course leading to a certificate. Prior study of law isn't required, but if undertaken, mention which modules were of interest and why; the same applies to other relevant courses.

Beyond education

The firm wants to learn as much as possible about the candidate beyond their studies — how they manage time effectively, and how these activities will help a career in law. This includes hobbies and interests, positions of responsibility held, and books, articles or podcasts that have bolstered legal sector knowledge, as well as any legal open days, events, or work simulations attended (current or historic, virtual or in person).

This is also where to select specific tasks from work experience and give an in-depth explanation of what was done and the transferable skills gained — the firm is especially interested in which of these resonated most, and why they helped prepare for a legal career.

Why Farrer & Co specifically

Use this section to give examples of what specifically led to applying to Farrer & Co, and what stands out when compared to other law firms. Before answering, take time to research the firm and its solicitor apprenticeship programme specifically — the firm recommends using the large selection of articles, blog posts, podcasts and videos available on its website and social media platforms.

16. Personal Fit & Application Angles

Drafted talking points connecting personal motivations and experience to the firm's positioning — for use/refinement in application answers.

- Farrer's client work often requires deep psychological insight — understanding how clients perceive risk, reputation, legacy and personal identity. This aligns with a background in psychology and communications — helping legal strategy consider how people think and react under stress
- Farrer's reputation and crisis management practice is not just about legal technicalities, but crafting compelling narratives that safeguard personal and institutional reputations. Marketing skills give an edge in understanding how narratives shape public perception and client trust
- Experience leading tours, communicating across age groups, and building rapport mirrors the relationship-centric ethos of Farrer's advisory style, where trust and continuity are strategic assets
- Firms like Withers focus on global clients, but Farrer's blend of tradition with personal, bespoke advice positions it to handle clients who value authentic human connection alongside legal excellence — experience at open evenings, subject ambassador roles, and marketing strategy shows emotional intelligence plus strategic framing, highly relevant to this advising model

I am particularly drawn to Farrer's psychologically informed approach to legal work, most clearly demonstrated in cases such as PN v SA, where the firm helped shape judicial understanding of coercive influence. Studying psychology alongside law has reinforced my belief that effective legal advice depends on understanding human behaviour, emotion and power dynamics — an approach that sits at the heart of Farrer's family and reputation practices.

From a marketing perspective, I admire Farrer's understated positioning. The firm's reputation is built through referral, results and trust rather than scale or aggressive branding. This reflects my own belief that the strongest organisations rely on substance and consistency, not noise.

Farrer & Co's position as a trusted adviser to families, charities and institutions reflects a commitment to integrity over volume. Its single-office London model and focus on continuity allow the firm to build deep, long-term relationships in matters where discretion and judgement are critical. This strongly aligns with my own leadership experience, where I have been trusted with responsibility and valued clear, principled decision-making over visibility.

Farrer & Co's emphasis on an inclusive, collaborative culture resonates strongly with me. The firm's investment in people and its recognition for lived inclusion suggest an environment where individuals are encouraged to contribute authentically. My leadership style similarly prioritises approachability, adaptability and bringing others with me.

Additional prompts to develop

- First pull to law
- Why commercial law
- Why an apprenticeship
- What I will gain from the apprenticeship
- Mention Young Enterprise experience for collaboration — raised significant funds
- Link stated values (partnership, integrity, excellence) to personal life and extracurriculars
- Work experience write-up angle: prestige, private client work, luxury assets, client relationships, respect, loyalty, understanding and tailored communication, team-first mindset, trusted with sensitivity, professional restraint, longevity of advice, leading specialists in art and cultural property

17. Overall Aims & Values (Quick Reference)

PRESTIGE	CLIENT RELATIONSHIPS	COLLABORATION	HIGH-VALUE CASES	RESPECT	TAILORED COMMUNICATION	TEAMWORK
TEAM-FIRST MINDSET	TRUSTED WITH SENSITIVITY	ADVISING THROUGH UNCERTAINTY	PROFESSIONAL RESTRAINT	LONGEVITY OF ADVICE		
EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE	CONSISTENCY	PROTECTING DIGNITY AND POSITION				

Sources: Farrer & Co website and practice area pages; firm awards and press coverage (2025); LawWorks Pro Bono Awards; recruiter/apprenticeship guidance materials. Compiled as private research — verify current salary, deadline and programme details against the live listing before applying.